

SEEDHI BAAT ON AAJ TAK

"Ability to expose is an advantage"

ACTOR NISHA KOTHARI SPOKE TO EDITOR PRABHU CHAWLA about her upcoming film and philosophies.

Q. Is your film titled Aag because of you?

A. No. There are several other things in this film that make it explosive.

Q. What role are you playing in this film?

A. I am playing the role of a *tapori* Mumbai girl, Ghungaroo, in this film. She is a tomboy and the only girl in Mumbai who drives an autorickshaw.

Q. What do you think Ram Gopal Varma saw in you that he cast you in this film?

A. He did a photo shoot with me but didn't tell me that we were doing it for Ghungaroo's character. He liked my photographs and offered me the role.

Q. You are playing one of the central characters.

A. I am not playing a central character. The story revolves around the rivalry between Babban and Narsimha. I am just playing an external character.

Q. Don't you feel there'll be a lot of comparisons between you and Hema Malini since you are playing a character similar in spirit to the one she played in Sholay?

A. Though the spirit is the same, but there is a lot of difference in both the characters. So, there can be no comparison.

Q. Once you do this role, you will be clubbed in the category of those heroines who not only act but expose too. What do you feel about that?

A. I don't mind doing glamorous roles. We do such things only when the director, producer and the audience ask for it. Exposure should be done within limits.

Q. Do you think exposure, along with acting, is necessary for success?

A. Acting is the most important thing. All other things are secondary. However, the ability to expose gives an added advantage.

Q. Is it true that you declined a film because it had a kissing scene?

A. No. All these are mere rumours.

Q. Do you want to become a Mala Sinha, Meena Kumari or a Vijayanthimala?

A. I want to see myself as Nisha Kothari. I do not want to imitate anyone.

Seedhi Baat is telecast on Aaj Tak at 8.30 p.m. every Sunday and 3.30 p.m. every Monday

Full text of the interview at:

<http://www.indiatoday.com>

BHASKAR PAUL



FREE, FOR NOW: Dutt apply for regular bail thereafter. He has been sentenced to six years' imprisonment by the TADA court in the 1993 Mumbai bomb blasts case.

Over the past few days, Dutt's family and friends have tried to maintain a low profile to avoid interfering with the court's proceedings. His sister and Congress MP Priya Dutt has been camping in Delhi and had even met

Interim Freedom

MUMBAI After 20 days of shuttling between jails and drawing media frenzy, actor Sanjay Dutt is out on bail. The Supreme Court, on August 20, granted him and five others interim bail till the time the TADA court in Mumbai does not provide a copy of the final judgement. He will have to surrender before the court the day the judgement arrives and can

Congress President Sonia Gandhi to discuss ways of seeking bail for her brother.

The actor will now have to report before the CBI every week. He will have to seek permission each time he wants to step out of the country as his passport will remain with the trial court. But it's a small price for freedom.

by Aditi Pai

YASIN DAR



SRINAGAR Devastated by a fire that partially destroyed the army's largest ammunition depot on August 11, thousands of people are still living in makeshift camps near the Khandroo village. Officials say it would take over a month to clean up the area even as a number of bomb disposal squad members are on the job of clearing the fields and homes where hundreds of

RAVAGED: Villages around the depot

live shells are still scattered. Though there is talk of relocation, questions of livelihood remain. It will be difficult for poor peasants to look for alternative sources of earning in such an event. While doubts persist, one thing is certain—they cannot continue to live under the hanging sword of the depot. by Aljaz Hussain